Giridhar Dhananjay Khaza Venkata

Cergy, France
giridhardhananjay.khazavenkata@essec.edu | +33 (0)7 45 51 61 40 | linkedin.com/in/giridhar99

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Lacoste — Recruitment Team
Paris

Re: Application for ALTERNANCE - Acheteur(se) Retail (H/F) (12-13 months apprenticeship, starting September 2026)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the ALTERNANCE - Acheteur(se) Retail (H/F) apprenticeship at Lacoste in Paris, starting September 2026. I have three years of experience across business development, consulting and analysis, most recently as a Strategy and Marketing Corporate Consultant at FORVIA in Paris, and I am looking for an apprenticeship in purchasing at a company I can build a career with rather than pass through.

Lacoste plans a seasonal range across markets that behave differently, so central planning is where the brand's single view meets a dozen local realities — and master data is what decides whether that view is real or fictional. The role itself covers retail purchasing for the brand's store network — reconciling one brand view with markets that do not actually behave the same way, which is the harder and more interesting version of the planning problem.

Purchasing is where my experience is most directly transferable. At GEP Worldwide I drafted RFIs, RFQs and RFPs, analysed the responses, and ran the market research behind a car-fleet procurement decision that saved a client 6%. At FORVIA I now produce competitor and cost analysis that Purchasing uses alongside Finance, M&A, Sales, R&D, Operations and Legal, so I am used to sourcing questions being argued across functions rather than settled inside one. My two years at Endosys Technologies were spent on the supplier's side of that table, negotiating and holding commercial relationships, which is a useful thing to have seen before sitting on the buyer's side of it.

I am currently completing a Master in Management at ESSEC Business School, with coursework in Strategy and Management, Marketing Management, and People and Organizations. Before that I completed a B.Tech in Mechanical Engineering at the National Institute of Technology Calicut (ranked #21 in India, NIRF 2025), covering Operations Research, Project Management, Supply Chain Management, Quality Planning and Analysis, and Management of Production Systems. The engineering degree is where my analytical edge comes from — it taught me to break a problem down to what can actually be measured before arguing about it — and ESSEC has given me the strategic and commercial judgement to put that to work.

I am available from September 2026 and would welcome the chance to discuss how I could contribute to your team. Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,
Giridhar Dhananjay Khaza Venkata